Forward Kinematics Design

Preface: On the Raspberry Pi 5 and Jetson-nano, ROS runs in Docker, so the MoveIt2 experience is limited; it is recommended that Raspberry Pi 5 and Jetson-nano users run MoveIt2-related cases on a virtual machine. On the Orin board, ROS runs directly on the board, so Orin board users can run MoveIt2-related cases directly on the board, using the same commands as running on a virtual machine. This section will use running on a virtual machine as the example for demonstration.

1. Content Description

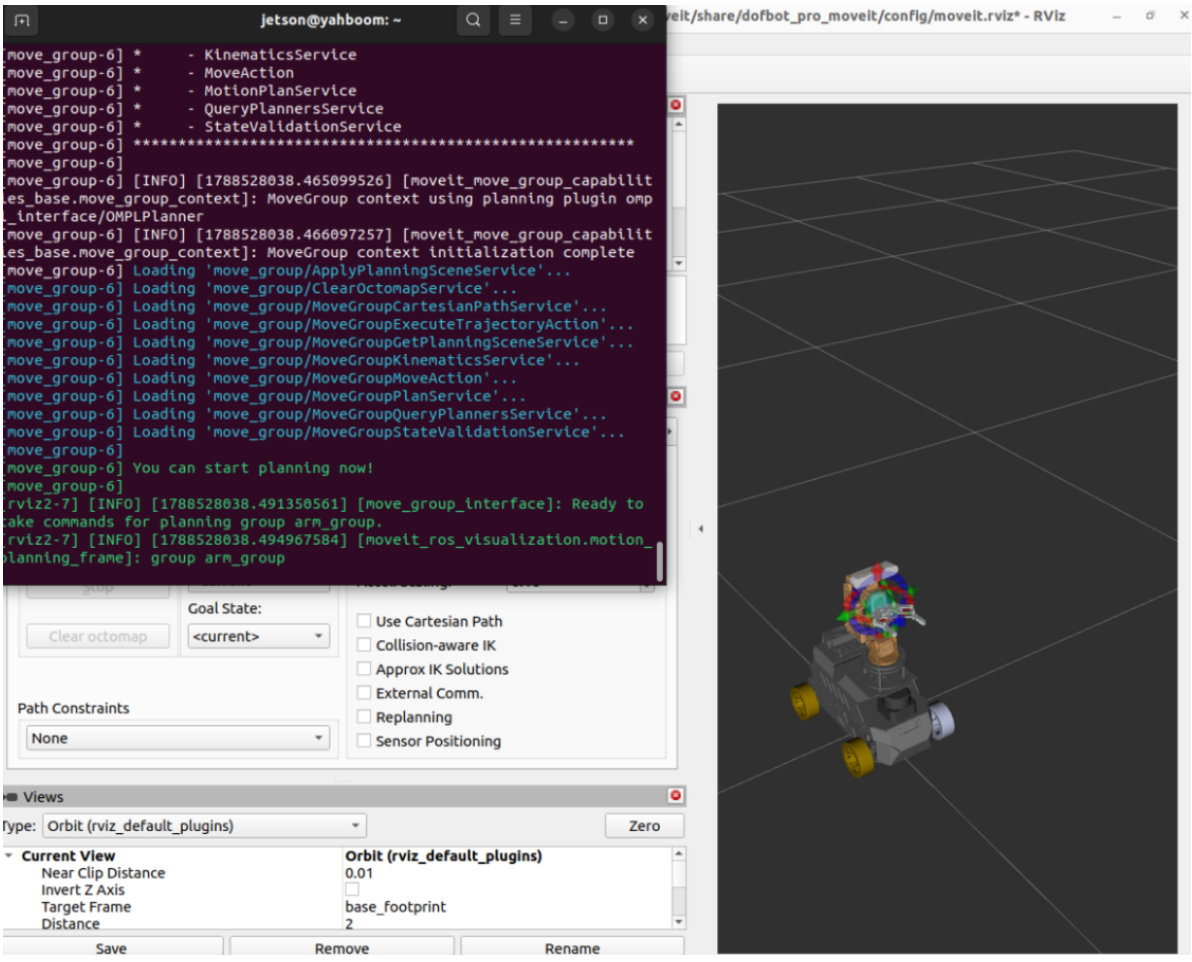
This course explains how to call the functions in the MoveIt library to implement forward kinematics design of the robot arm. Forward kinematics design refers to computing the pose of the robot arm's end effector based on the joint angles. Here, in RViz, we specify the angle of each joint, and then let MoveIt2 plan and move to this pose.

2. Launch

Enter the following command in the terminal to launch the MoveIt2 simulation environment:

```
ros2 launch dofbot_pro_moveit demo_3d.launch.py
```

Once the program starts, when **You can start planning now!** appears in the terminal, it means the startup was successful, as shown in the figure below:



If you want the simulated robot arm to be linked with the real physical robot arm (optional), open another terminal to run the real-machine driver node:

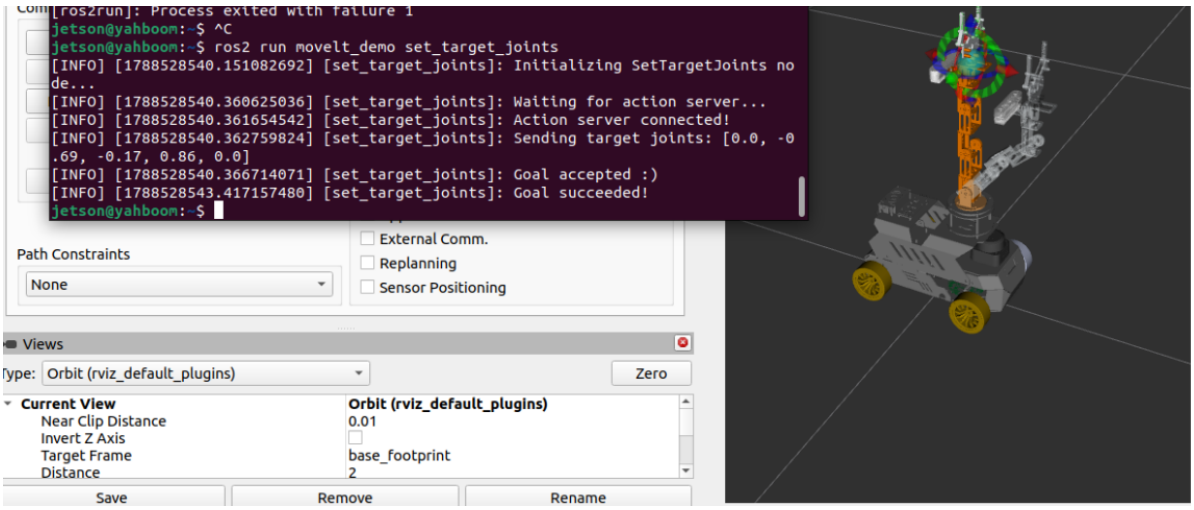
```
ros2 run movelt_demo SimulationToMachine
```

(It is recommended not to start this node during the initial test. First verify that the obstacle-avoidance trajectory is correct in the pure RViz simulation environment before connecting to the real machine).

Then enter the following command in another terminal to launch the forward kinematics joint angle setting program:

```
ros2 run movelt_demo set_target_joints
```

After the program runs, the robot arm in RViz (as well as the physical robot arm) will smoothly plan and move to the target pose of each preset joint angle, as shown in the figure below:



3. Core Code Analysis

Program source code path:
`~/yahboomcar_ros2_ws/dofbot_pro_ws/src/movelt_demo/movelt_demo/set_target_joints.py`

3.1 Forward Kinematics Principles and Target Joint Configuration

Forward Kinematics (FK) refers to computing the 3D pose of the robot arm's end effector in the base coordinate frame from the angles of each joint, $\theta_1, \theta_2, ..., \theta_n$, using the link parameters.

The node sends the specified joint angles directly through the `FollowJointTrajectory` Action interface:

```
import rclpy
from rclpy.node import Node
from rclpy.action import ActionClient
from control_msgs.action import FollowJointTrajectory
from trajectory_msgs.msg import JointTrajectory, JointTrajectoryPoint
from builtin_interfaces.msg import Duration

class SetTargetJoints(Node):
    def __init__(self):
        super().__init__('set_target_joints')
```

```
        self.get_logger().info("Initializing SetTargetJoints node...")

        # 1. Create the Action client to connect to the controller
        self._action_client = ActionClient(
            self,
            FollowJointTrajectory,
            '/arm_group_controller/follow_joint_trajectory'
        )

        # 2. Robot arm joint names (kept fully consistent with URDF/SRDF)
        self.joint_names = [
            "arm1_Joint",
            "arm2_Joint",
            "arm3_Joint",
            "arm4_Joint",
            "arm5_Joint"
        ]

        # 3. Preset target joint angles (in radians)
        # These correspond to the angle values of axes 1 through 5: [0.0, -0.69,
-0.17, 0.86, 0.0]
        self.target_joints = [0.0, -0.69, -0.17, 0.86, 0.0]

        self.get_logger().info("Waiting for action server...")
        self._action_client.wait_for_server()
        self.get_logger().info("Action server connected!")
```

3.2 Constructing the Trajectory Point and Sending the Goal

Package the given joint angles into a `JointTrajectoryPoint`, set a smooth motion duration (3 seconds), and the controller will perform smooth interpolation based on spline curves:

```
    def send_goal(self):
        goal_msg = FollowJointTrajectory.Goal()
        trajectory = JointTrajectory()
        trajectory.joint_names = self.joint_names

        # Create a single trajectory endpoint
        point = JointTrajectoryPoint()
        point.positions = self.target_joints
        point.velocities = [0.0] * len(self.target_joints)
        point.time_from_start = Duration(sec=3, nanosec=0)  # Move smoothly into
place in 3 seconds

        trajectory.points.append(point)
        goal_msg.trajectory = trajectory

        self.get_logger().info(f"Sending target joints: {self.target_joints}")
        self._send_goal_future = self._action_client.send_goal_async(goal_msg)
        self._send_goal_future.add_done_callback(self.goal_response_callback)

    def get_result_callback(self, future):
        result = future.result().result
        if result.error_code == 0:
            self.get_logger().info('Forward kinematics target pose executed
successfully!')
        else:
```

```
            self.get_logger().error(f'Execution failed, error code:
{result.error_code}')
        rclpy.shutdown()
```